

GENDER



BENDERS

Dhruv Chakrabarti vs Sneha Patel Finding The Hardware Configuration



15 sec

Dhruv looks completely 'chillaxed' and smiles at the simplicity of the task. He promptly right clicks the 'My Computer' icon and enters 'Properties'. The 'System Properties' dialog box soon appears, and he then clicks the 'Hardware' tab. Dhruv zeroes in on the 'Device Manager' that displays the hardware configuration of the entire system. What, done already?



52 sec

Sneha is slightly anxious. She clicks on the Start menu and opens the Control panel. She selects the 'System' icon and the same 'System Properties' dialog box appears. But instead of clicking the 'Device Manager' tab, Sneha clicks on 'Hardware Profiles', which is as good as a dead end. Repeated clicking makes no difference. She finally sees the light and hits 'Device Manager'. She has it right, but just a little late.

same way that people schedule specific times to watch their favourite TV shows. The answer, of course, is to let the listener pick the time. Podcasting's distribution model is transparent: the shows you want get dropped into your mobile audio device as they air, and you can listen to them, pause them, and resume listening whenever you want.

Radio stations face an

uphill battle today getting to this kind of position. A station might own the commentary and the voice talent, and might even have the rights to use the music on air, but those rights may not extend to on-demand Internet broadcast. Once these licensing issues are sorted out, radio stations and networks might just find huge success adopting the podcasters' model.

IT'S A CPU, IT'S A MODEM,
IT'S BOTH!

Cheaper Chip For Multimedia Mobiles

Here's a mobile phone chip that combines a modem and processor on one bit of silicon! In a bid to bring down the cost of making mobile phones capable of supporting 3D gaming and 30-frames-a-second video, Texas Instruments (TI) has developed the OMAP-Vox chip, which is currently being tested by firms in Europe and Asia, and could appear by the end of the year.

TI's initiative seeks to make multimedia functions such as video and gaming more affordable.

FIRST SPAM, NOW SPIM

Spimmers Beware!

US teenager Anthony Greco, 18, has earned the dubious distinction of being the first person to be arrested for sending unsolicited instant messages—or 'spim'.

Greco is said to have sent 1.5 million messages that advertised pornography and mortgage-related information to members of MySpace.com, an online networking service.

To top it all, Greco allegedly threatened to share his spam tools and

methods if MySpace.com didn't sign an exclusive marketing deal that would legitimise his messages.

Greco was apprehended by the police in Los Angeles International airport after he made the trip from New York. He walked straight into the trap that the cops had laid for him—making him believe that MySpace President, Tom Anderson, called him to LA to sign the deal that would legalise his spim.

The popularity of online networking groups and IMs have led to the rise of unsolicited IM spim, which is considered to be much more obtrusive than spam—because spim is delivered to you wherever you are, without warning and without filters.

CENTRALISING COMPUTING ASSETS

ClearCube Brings PC Blade to India

With most companies trying to decentralise operations, data security is a growing concern. ClearCube Technology, the pioneer in PC blade technology, announced its entry into the Indian market in a press conference on February 16, 2005. ClearCube is targeting mid-size and large organisations. Commenting on the India launch, Raj Shah, Global Chief Marketing Officer, ClearCube, said, "We

Microsoft's Peabody Platform

Microsoft recently unveiled Peabody, a GSM/GPRS mobile phone platform designed and integrated by Singapore-based Flextronics. The platform is based on Microsoft's Windows Mobile software, and is a low-cost option that has almost all the common smartphone features. Available only to OEMs, Peabody (named after

the charming and cerebral dog from the *Rocky and Bullwinkle* cartoon show) can be made to order.

It's not so much that Peabody phones will be crammed full of new features, but that they'll be crammed full of today's common smartphone features cheap.

Buzzword
of the MONTH